

simpleDocs

A small Windows assistant that explains selected code and technical text without pulling you away from your work.

Quick start

- 1 Extract the ZIP, then open CodeExplainer.exe. No account or sign-in is required.
- 2 Select code, an error, terminal output, or technical text in the application you are using.
- 3 Press Ctrl+Shift+Space. Read the short explanation in the popup, then continue where you were.

What it does

simpleDocs captures the text you select and, when available, a limited amount of nearby context. It sends that information to the hosted simpleDocs service, which streams a concise explanation back to the popup. The goal is to reduce repeated copying, searching, and switching between your editor, browser, terminal, and an AI chat.

Using it well

Select the smallest complete line or block that represents your question. For errors, include the exact message and the most relevant stack-trace line. Internet access is required. Selected text and nearby captured context are sent to the service, so do not select passwords, API keys, personal records, or other sensitive information.

If the popup does not appear

Select the text again and press Ctrl+Shift+Space once. Check that simpleDocs is visible in the Windows system tray and that your internet connection is working. If the problem continues, note the application you were using and what happened before contacting us.

Our research

simpleDocs grew from our presented paper, An OS-Level Contextual AI Assistant for Reducing Context Switching in Novice Programming Workflows. Our research explores whether useful explanations can appear inside a learner's current workflow, helping novice programmers stay focused while reading code, learning, and debugging.

Thank you for using our tool

Your experience and feedback will help me improve simpleDocs and continue this research. Kindly connect with me on LinkedIn and tell me what worked well or what could be better.

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